
Can a teammate use this prompt safely on their own?
Prompt Card
Problem
Turn meeting notes into clear next steps.
Input
{Meeting_Notes}
Output format
Decisions
Actions
Open Questions
Limits
Use only the notes.
If an owner or date is missing, write "Not stated".
Human checks
Check names (match the notes)
Check dates (match the notes)
Check decisions (match the notes)
Meeting_Notes
Output (using the prompt card)
Decisions
Actions
Open Questions

What problem are we solving?

Learn how to document a tested prompt as a prompt card: fill in seven fixed fields, test the card with a new user, and include clear limits and human checks.

THE SITUATION

The problem

Rina's weekly recap template from Session 4.1 works well. Next week she goes on vacation, and her teammate Marco must write the recaps. Her root problem is that Marco has never used the template. She sent him only the prompt text in a chat message. Marco pasted the notes in the wrong place, used the prompt on a customer email, and sent a recap with a wrong date without checking it. Rina's idea is to ask ChatGPT to write instructions for the prompt. ChatGPT wrote a 300-word description that called the prompt "powerful" and "time-saving," but it did not say what to paste, when not to use it, or what to check. A useful prompt needs a short card that another person can follow alone.

Today's goal and a three-step method

Learn how to document a tested prompt as a prompt card: fill in seven fixed fields, test the card with a new user, and include clear limits and human checks.

STEP 1

Fill all seven fields

Use the tested prompt and write each field in one or two short sentences.

STEP 2

Test the handoff

Ask someone, or the AI acting as a new teammate, to read only the card and list what is unclear.

STEP 3

Fix and try it on new input

Revise the card once, then run it on new input and use the human checks.

The tested prompt (from Session 4.1)

Fictional data created for this class. File: data/session_4_4_prompt_card_fields.csv

CASE FACTS

The tested prompt (from Session 4.1)

- "You turn meeting notes into a weekly recap. Use only the notes below. Write exactly these four sections: 1. Decisions 2. Actions, as a table with the columns Task | Owner | Due date 3. Open questions 4. Next meeting. If an owner or a date is not in the notes, write 'Not stated.' Do not add anything that is not in the notes. Notes: {Meeting_Notes}"

The seven fields of a prompt card

Fictional data created for this class. File: data/session_4_4_prompt_card_fields.csv

Field	What it answers
Task	What problem does the prompt solve?
Intended user	Who should use it?
Input	What do I paste, and where?
Prompt	The exact template to copy
Output format	What will the answer look like?
Do not use when	When must I not use it?
Human checks	Three yes/no checks before I share the output

Five documentation words you need first

Before you share a prompt, you must know these words. Each example uses Rina's recap template.

KEY IDEA

Prompt card

A short page that explains one tested prompt with fixed fields, so anyone can use it the same way.

KEY IDEA

Handoff

Giving your work to another person so they can do it without you. Example: Marco writes the recaps while Rina is away.

KEY IDEA

Input instructions

Exactly what to paste and where. Example: "Paste this week's meeting notes in place of {Meeting_Notes}."

Five documentation words you need first (continued)

Before you share a prompt, you must know these words. Each example uses Rina's recap template.

KEY IDEA

Do-not-use condition

A situation where the prompt must not be used. Example: "Do not use for customer emails or any text with customer personal data."

KEY IDEA

Human check

A yes/no check a person does before sharing the output. Example: "Every name in the recap matches the notes."

Why the first handoff failed

"Here is my prompt" and "here is how to use my prompt" are different things. Check what Rina sent to Marco.

Card field	In Rina's chat message?	What went wrong
Task	No	Marco did not know what the prompt was for
Intended user	No	Not a problem this time
Input	No	He pasted the notes in the wrong place
Prompt	Yes	(sent)
Output format	No	He did not know what a correct recap looks like
Do not use when	No	He used it on a customer email
Human checks	No	He sent a wrong date without checking

Why the first handoff failed (key points)

"Here is my prompt" and "here is how to use my prompt" are different things. Check what Rina sent to Marco.

KEY POINTS

What the table shows

- Rina's message had 1 of the 7 fields. Each missing field led to a mistake.
- The AI-written description was long, but it had no input instructions, no do-not-use condition, and no human checks. Long is not the same as useful.

How the three-step method fixes the handoff

The instructor runs Poor Prompt 1 and Improved Prompts 1 and 2 below in front of the class and compares the answers.

KEY IDEA

Step 1 fixes the missing-information problem

Seven fixed fields make sure nothing important is left out.

KEY IDEA

Step 2 fixes the "it is clear to me" problem

The writer always understands their own card. A new reader finds the unclear parts.

KEY IDEA

Step 3 fixes the unchecked-output problem

Human checks on new input show that the card works without the writer.

Poor prompt 1

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You
Write documentation for my meeting recap prompt so my team can use it.

Message AI...

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

A long, friendly description that says the prompt is "powerful" and "saves hours," with general tips such as "review the output."

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- It does not include the prompt, so the AI describes a prompt it has never seen.
- It gives no fields, so the AI writes marketing text instead of instructions.
- Nothing in the answer says what to paste, when not to use the prompt, or what to check.

Poor prompt 2

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Here is my prompt. Explain it to my teammate in detail so he understands it:
You turn meeting notes into a weekly recap. Use only the notes below.
Write exactly these four sections: 1. Decisions 2. Actions, as a table with
the columns Task | Owner | Due date 3. Open questions 4. Next meeting.
If an owner or a date is not in the notes, write "Not stated."
Do not add anything that is not in the notes.
Notes: {Meeting_Notes}

Message AI...

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

A long, line-by-line explanation of each instruction, with no limits and no checks.

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- "Explain in detail" produces a long text that a busy teammate will not read.
- It explains how the prompt works, not how to use it safely.
- It has no do-not-use condition and no human checks, the two fields that would have stopped Marco's mistakes.

Improved prompt 1

Steps 1 and 2. Copy this prompt exactly.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Make a prompt card for the tested prompt below.
Use exactly these seven fields: Task; Intended user; Input (what to paste
and where); Prompt (copy it exactly); Output format; Do not use when; Human checks (three yes/no checks).
Write one or two short sentences per field, except the Prompt field.
Do not change the prompt. Keep the card under 200 words, not counting the prompt.

Tested prompt:
You turn meeting notes into a weekly recap. Use only the notes below.
Write exactly these four sections: 1. Decisions 2. Actions, as a table with the columns Task | Owner | Due date 3. Open questions 4. Next meeting.
If an owner or a date is not in the notes, write "Not stated."
Do not add anything that is not in the notes.
Notes: {Meeting_Notes}

Message AI...

Why it works: improved prompt 1

Each part of the prompt matters.

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- It gives the real prompt, which fixes the problem in Poor Prompt 1.
- Seven fixed fields make sure input, limits, and checks are included.
- "Do not change the prompt" keeps the tested version safe.
- The word limit keeps the card short enough to read in one minute.
- Three yes/no checks give the user a clear routine before sharing.

Improved prompt 2

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Now test the card. Act as Marco, a new teammate who has never seen this prompt.
Read only the card, not this conversation.
List up to three things that are unclear or missing for you.
For each one, suggest one sentence to add to the card.
Then show the revised card.

Message AI...

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- Acting as a new user finds gaps that the writer cannot see.
- "Read only the card" makes the test fair: Marco will not have this chat.
- Up to three items keeps the revision small and focused.
- The revised card is ready to save in the team's shared folder.

Exercise 1: Build the prompt card

Guided practice. Follow the steps in order.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Steps

1. Open ChatGPT and start a **new chat**. Copy Poor Prompt 1 from the box above, paste it, and send it. Count how many of the seven card fields the answer includes. You will need the count for your report.
2. Start another **new chat**, so the first answer does not affect the second. Copy Improved Prompt 1, paste it, and send it.
3. Check that all seven fields are present and that the Prompt field matches the tested prompt word for word. Compare with the answer key below.
4. In the same chat, copy Improved Prompt 2, paste it, and send it. Check that the revised card answers the unclear points.
5. For the Results section of your report, write the field count for Poor Prompt 1 and the final card.

Answer key

Use this table to check the AI.

Field	Example content
Task	Turn weekly meeting notes into a recap with the same four sections.
Intended user	Any member of the website team.
Input	Paste this week's meeting notes in place of {Meeting_Notes}.
Prompt	The tested prompt, copied exactly.
Output format	Decisions; Actions (Task, Owner, Due date); Open questions; Next meeting.
Do not use when	The input is not meeting notes (for example, a customer email) or contains customer personal data.
Human checks	1. Every name matches the notes. 2. Every date matches the notes. 3. Every decision is in the notes, and missing owners say "Not stated."

Exercise 2: Use the card on new input

Applied practice with a template.

HOW IT WORKS

Read first

- Marco now uses only the card. Before running the prompt, he must check the "Do not use when" field. Use this template. Replace each part in square brackets.

TEMPLATE - FILL IN, THEN SEND

AI Chat

You

Here is a prompt card: [the final card from Exercise 1].
Here is the input: [the input].
First, check the "Do not use when" field. Is this input allowed? Answer yes or no and why.
If yes, run the prompt on the input and then answer the three human checks.
If no, stop and say what Marco should do instead.

Message AI...

Part A: Worked example (run it)

Copy and send this completed prompt in the same chat.

PART A - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Here is a prompt card: (paste the final card from Exercise 1 here)
Here is the input: Pricing page published Tuesday. Ana collects customer
feedback by Friday. The team will decide on a summer sale at the next meeting.
Next check-in Monday.
First, check the "Do not use when" field. Is this input allowed? Answer yes or no and why.
If yes, run the prompt on the input and then answer the three human checks.
If no, stop and say what Marco should do instead.

Message AI...

CHECK THE ANSWER

Expected result

The input is allowed (it is meeting notes). Decisions: none yet; the summer sale has **not** been decided. Actions: collect customer feedback, Ana, Friday. Open question: will the team run a summer sale? Next meeting: Monday. All three human checks pass. If the recap says "summer sale approved," it fails check 3.

Part B: Your turn (write it)

Fill in the template yourself and send it.

YOUR TASK

Write your own prompt

The input is: "Customer email: The delivery was late again. My order number is 5521. Please call me at 555-0142." Fill in the template yourself with your card and this input, and send it.

CHECK THE ANSWER

Expected result

The input is **not** allowed. It is a customer email, not meeting notes, and it contains customer personal data (an order number and a phone number). A good answer stops and says that Marco should follow the customer support process and the privacy rules from Session 3.4 instead.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W16_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- **Introduction:** Explain Rina's root problem (Marco must use her prompt alone), what went wrong in the first handoff, and why a long description did not help.
- **Method:** Copy Poor Prompt 1, Improved Prompts 1 and 2, the Part A prompt, and the Part B prompt you wrote.
- **Results:** Include the field count for Poor Prompt 1, your final prompt card, the Week 4 recap with the three human checks, and the answer for the customer email.
- **Conclusion:** Explain whether Marco can now use the prompt safely on his own, in one or two sentences. Name one card field that made the biggest difference and one risk that remains.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- You can explain in one sentence why sending only the prompt text was not enough for Marco, and your Part B prompt stops at the "Do not use when" check without running the recap.